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# 1 Warnings, Errors, and Getting Help

## 1.1 Recommended reading and watching

- https://stackoverflow.com/a/5963610/3187973
  - https://github.com/jennybc/debugging#video

## 1.2 Messages, warnings, and errors

- *Message*: Things are fine, but here's some information you should know
- *Warning*: Uhhhh I'm gonna keep going, but maybe this isn't what you want
- *Error*: Nope. I'm stopping here. You need to fix the thing.

## 1.3 Where to go for help

- Isolate the problem
- Restart your session: Session → Restart R
- Local help: `?fun`
- StackOverflow: https://stackoverflow.com/questions/tagged/r
  - CRAN → BugReports (usually GitHub Issues)

```
library(lubridate)

some_data = c('June 2002', 'May 15, 2007', 'August 2007')
mdy(some_data)
parse_date_time(some_data, orders = 'mdY')
```

Let's try SO: https://stackoverflow.com/search?q=%5BR%5D+lubridate+month-year

```
parse_date_time(some_data, orders = c('mY', 'mdY'))
```

Here's another one:

```
more_data = c('May 7, 2017', 'May 19, 2017', 'May Fifth, 2017')
mdy(more_data)
```

SO doesn't seem so helpful: https://stackoverflow.com/search?q=%5BR%5D+lubridate+written+days

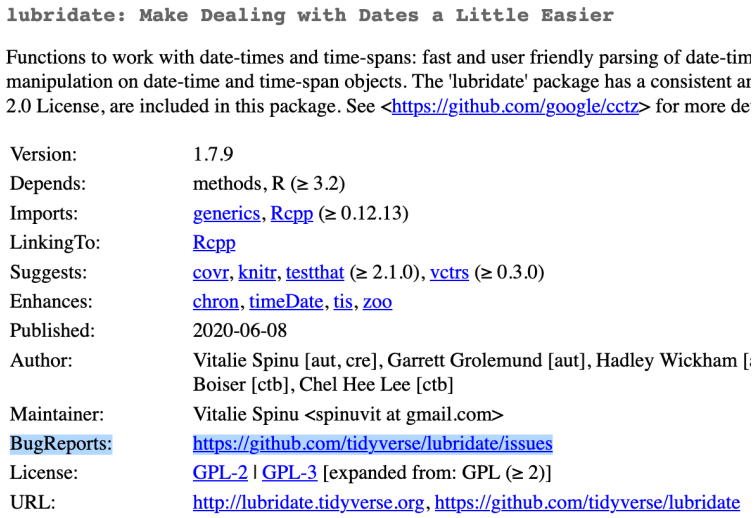
Let's check the CRAN page for `lubridate`: https://cran.r-project.org/web/packages/lubridate/index.html

Trying a couple of searches gives us a promising result: https://github.com/tidyverse/lubridate/issues?q=is%3Aissue+is%3Aopen+mdy

This is a known bug; it looks like they're thinking about doing something about it, but the only workaround is to create an NA: https://github.com/tidyverse/lubridate/issues/685

## 1.4 Writing a reproducible example: `reprex`

- https://reprex.tidyverse.org/

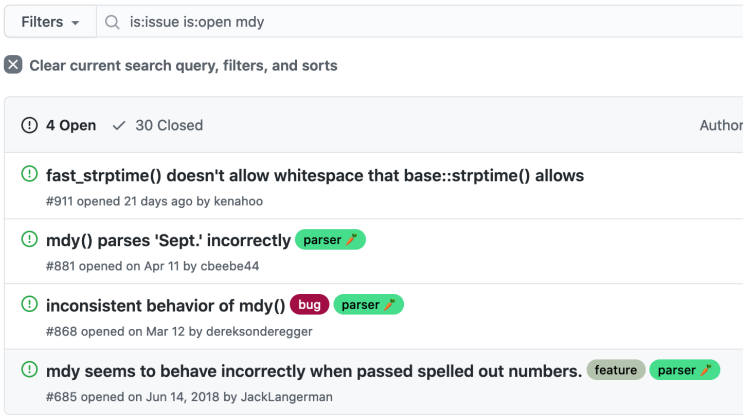


**lubridate: Make Dealing with Dates a Little Easier**

Functions to work with date-times and time-spans: fast and user friendly parsing of date-tim
manipulation on date-time and time-span objects. The 'lubridate' package has a consistent ar
2.0 License, are included in this package. See <https://github.com/google/cctz> for more de

| | |
|---|---|
| Version: | 1.7.9 |
| Depends: | methods, R (≥ 3.2) |
| Imports: | generics, Rcpp (≥ 0.12.13) |
| LinkingTo: | Rcpp |
| Suggests: | covr, knitr, testthat (≥ 2.1.0), vctrs (≥ 0.3.0) |
| Enhances: | chron, timeDate, tis, zoo |
| Published: | 2020-06-08 |
| Author: | Vitalie Spinu [aut, cre], Garrett Grolemund [aut], Hadley Wickham [ Boiser [ctb], Chel Hee Lee [ctb] |
| Maintainer: | Vitalie Spinu <spinuvit at gmail.com> |
| BugReports: | https://github.com/tidyverse/lubridate/issues |
| License: | GPL-2 \| GPL-3 [expanded from: GPL (≥ 2)] |
| URL: | http://lubridate.tidyverse.org, https://github.com/tidyverse/lubridate |

Figure 1: Screenshot of ‘lubridate‘ on CRAN, highlighting the BugReports field



Filters | is:issue is:open mdy

Clear current search query, filters, and sorts

4 Open | 30 Closed | Author

fast_strptime() doesn't allow whitespace that base::strptime() allows
#911 opened 21 days ago by kenahoo

mdy() parses 'Sept.' incorrectly parser
#881 opened on Apr 11 by cbeebe44

inconsistent behavior of mdy() bug parser
#868 opened on Mar 12 by dereksonderegger

mdy seems to behave incorrectly when passed spelled out numbers. feature parser
#685 opened on Jun 14, 2018 by JackLangerman

Figure 2: Screenshot of ‘lubridate‘ issues page, showing a relevant search result

- https://reprex.tidyverse.org/articles/articles/learn-reprex.html
- https://reprex.tidyverse.org/articles/reprex-dos-and-donts.html

### 1.5 Do not do these things in your reprex

If you do them, Jenny Bryan will come to your office and set your computer on fire.

- `setwd('/users/danhicks/projects/catsaregreat/myscript/')`
  - Used to ensure that R is running where your file is
  - Unnecessary if you're opening different projects in different RStudio sessions
  - Will cause irrelevant errors on any other system
  - Aside: use `file.path()` or `here::here()` to build paths
- `rm(list=ls())`
  - Used because people think it clears out the global environment
  - Unnecessary if you're regularly using Session → Restart R
  - Also unnecessary at the top of a `Rmd` file, which is always knit in a new session
  - Doesn't actually clear out the global environment
    * eg, doesn't unload packages or reset `options()`

Not on Bryan's list, but a bonus thing to not do:

- `require(package)`
  - If `package` is installed, will act just like `library()`
  - If not, will return `FALSE`
    * which generally means the script will keep going until you get some kind of error about a missing function sometime later
    * probably not the error you wanted help with
    * annoying to debug because I have no idea where the function is supposed to come from
  - If `library()` can't find the package, it immediately raises an error
    * I can tell right away what package needs to be installed